

welcome

to

West Chester

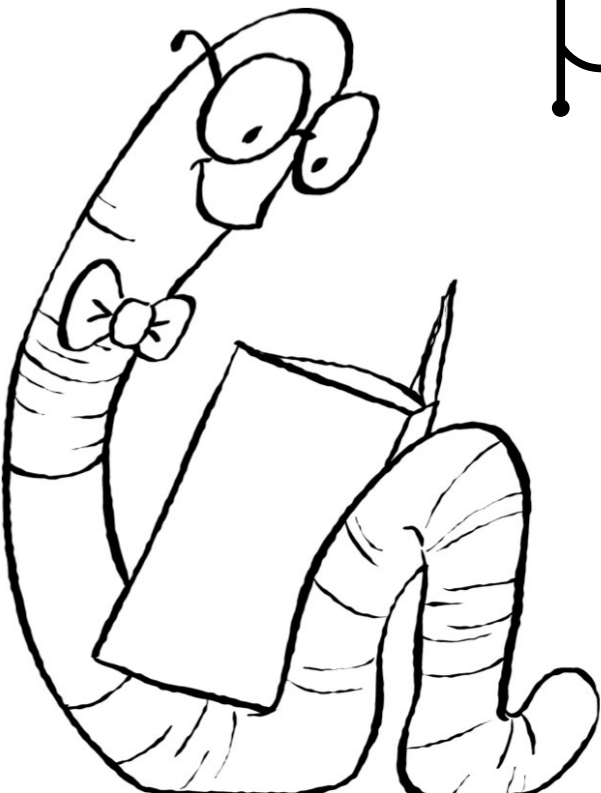
Preschool

PreK

A PARENT HANDBOOK

2026-27

Mrs. Lisa



Welcome to PreK at West Chester Preschool!

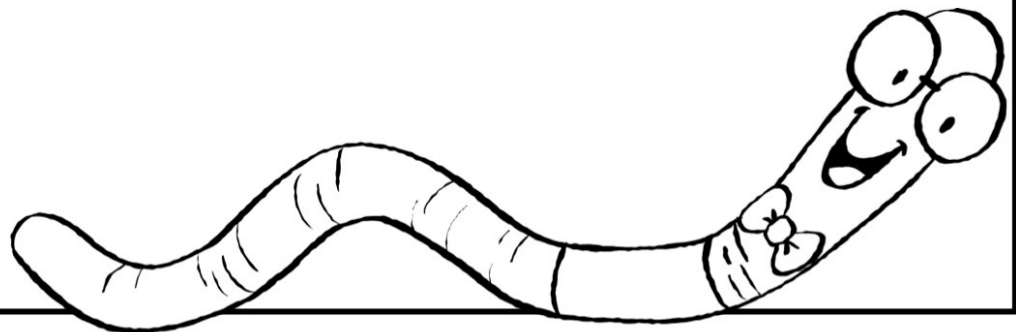
I am so happy to have your child in class this year! This handbook is designed to give you most, if not all, of the information about our class that you will need throughout the school year. Thank you for taking the time to read this information.

If you have any questions about the information contained in this handbook, feel free to email me at lisa@westchesterpreschool.org or call/text at 503-201-4775.

Welcome to the PreK classroom! I'm Mrs. Lisa, and I'm so excited to be starting this preschool journey with all of you. Ben and I have been blessed with three wonderful children: Mari, Jack, and Oliver. Before they were born, I taught in several states across the country. While I cherished the opportunity to stay home with my children when they were young, returning to the classroom at WCP felt like coming home. There's something truly magical about watching young minds grow and develop.

Our classroom will be a place of wonder and discovery. Through playful learning, we'll nurture curiosity, creativity, and a love for learning. I believe in creating a warm and supportive environment where every child feels valued and encouraged.

I can't wait to get to know each of you and your little ones. Please don't hesitate to reach out with any questions or concerns. Let's embark on this exciting preschool adventure together!



AM PreK Daily Schedule

9:15-9:30 Arrival/Tubbing

9:30-9:50 Literacy Circle Time

9:50-10:00 Whole Group Fine Motor

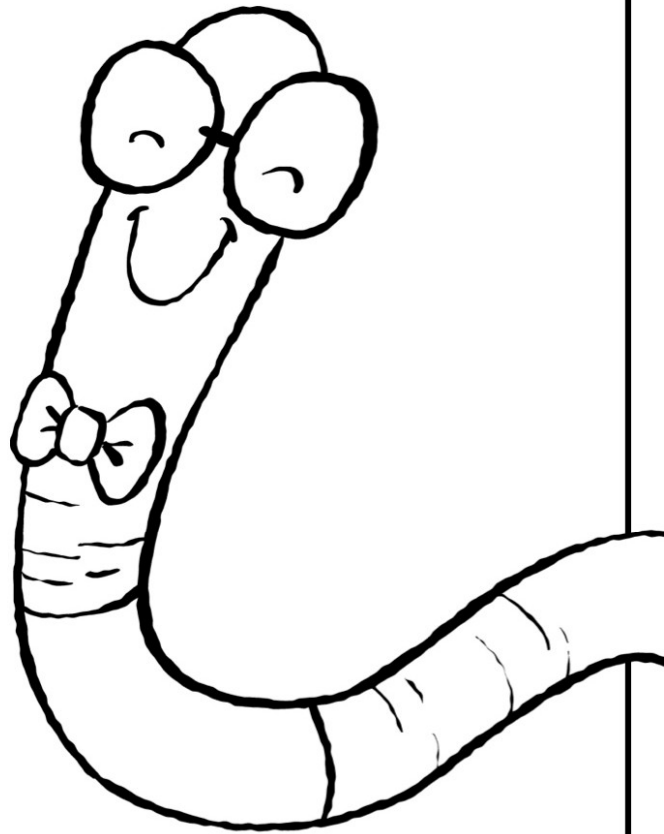
10:00-11:00 Centers

11:00-11:20 Restroom & Snack Time

11:20-11:40 Circle Time

11:40-12 Gross Motor

12:00 Dismissal



PM PreK Daily Schedule

12:30-12:45 Arrival/Tubbing

12:45-1:05 Literacy Circle Time

1:05-1:15 Whole Group Fine Motor

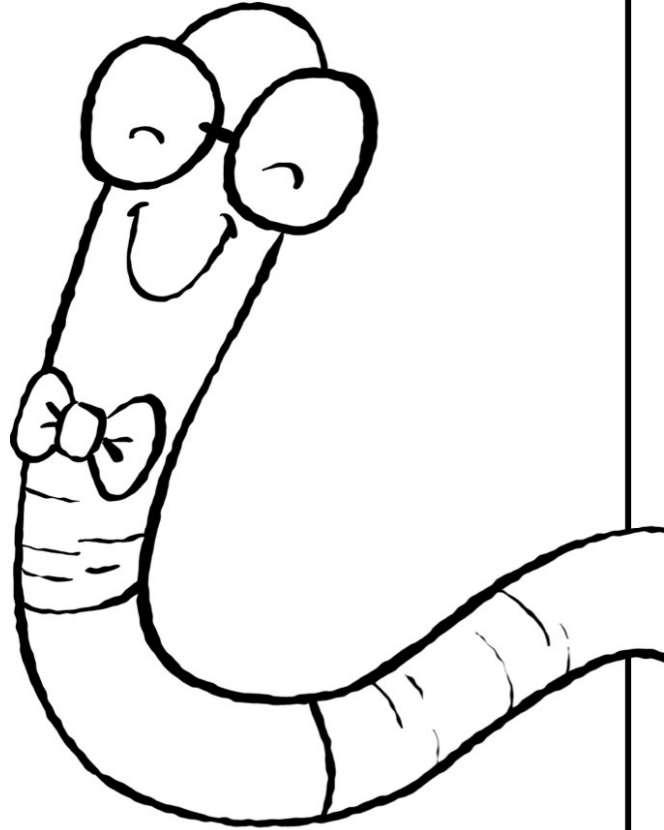
1:15-2:15 Centers

2:15-2:35 Restroom & Snack Time

2:35-2:55 Circle Time

2:55-3:15 Gross Motor

3:15 Dismissal



Classroom Rules

We try to keep this very simple and to the point for the children. The basic classroom rules are:

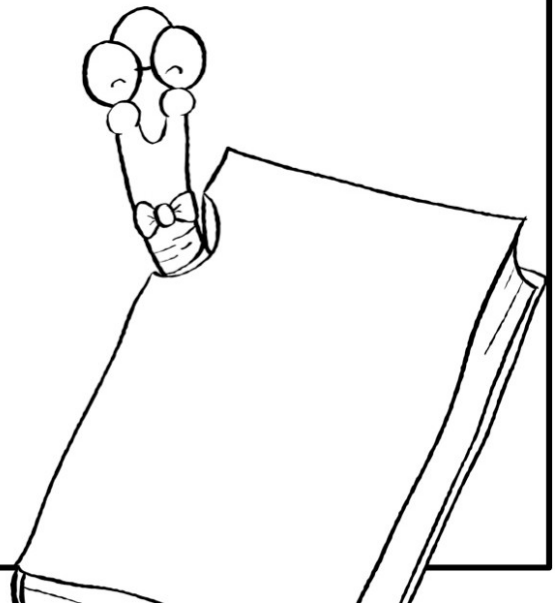
1. **I can use gentle hands and feet.**
2. **I can clean up the area when I am finished.**
3. **I can be kind and helpful.**
4. **I can play hard and have fun!**

Red/Green Choices

In our classroom, we use a system called Red and Green Choices to guide the children's behavior. Developmentally, the children are learning what choices are acceptable and expected (green) and which are not (red). We strive to make these teachable moments, rather than disciplinary.

Please see the folder pocket for a handout with more information about Red and Green Choices and how we will use them.

Adult helpers are encouraged to be equals in the classroom. It is important that the children know all adults are there to help them work through emotions and other learning situations. Along with Red and Green choices, the teacher will have information available about problem solving solutions as well as strategies for calming down.



Drop-off/Check-in Procedures

Check in begins at 9:15/12:30. Circle Time will begin at 9:30/12:45.

Restrooms

Please make sure your child uses the restroom & washes his/her hands before coming into the classroom.

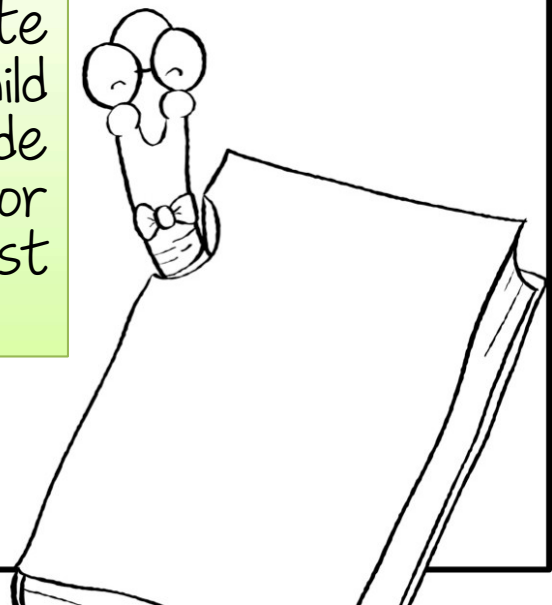
Entering the classroom

Parents/caregivers are welcome to come into the classroom! You may help lead your child complete the routine, but ultimately, we want the children to be responsible for following these steps each morning.

- 1. Hang up backpacks and jackets.**
- 2. Put their take home folder in their mailbox.**
- 3. Sign in by writing their name.**
- 4. Answer the Question of the Day.**
- 5. Play with materials in their morning tub until Calendar time.**

Separation is easiest when it is quick. Feel free to say goodbye at the door. The teacher and helpers can help make sure the rest of the steps are completed!

Please use drop off time to communicate any important information about your child to the teacher. Examples might include early pick-up, alternate pick-up person, or even "my child didn't sleep very well last night."



Dismissal Procedures

Please text the teacher if you will be late for pick up at noon/3:15. Adults picking up must be on the approved pick-up list kept on file at the school.

Dismiss from Playground

Children will line up at 11:55/3:10 and clean their hands with sanitizer before being dismissed.

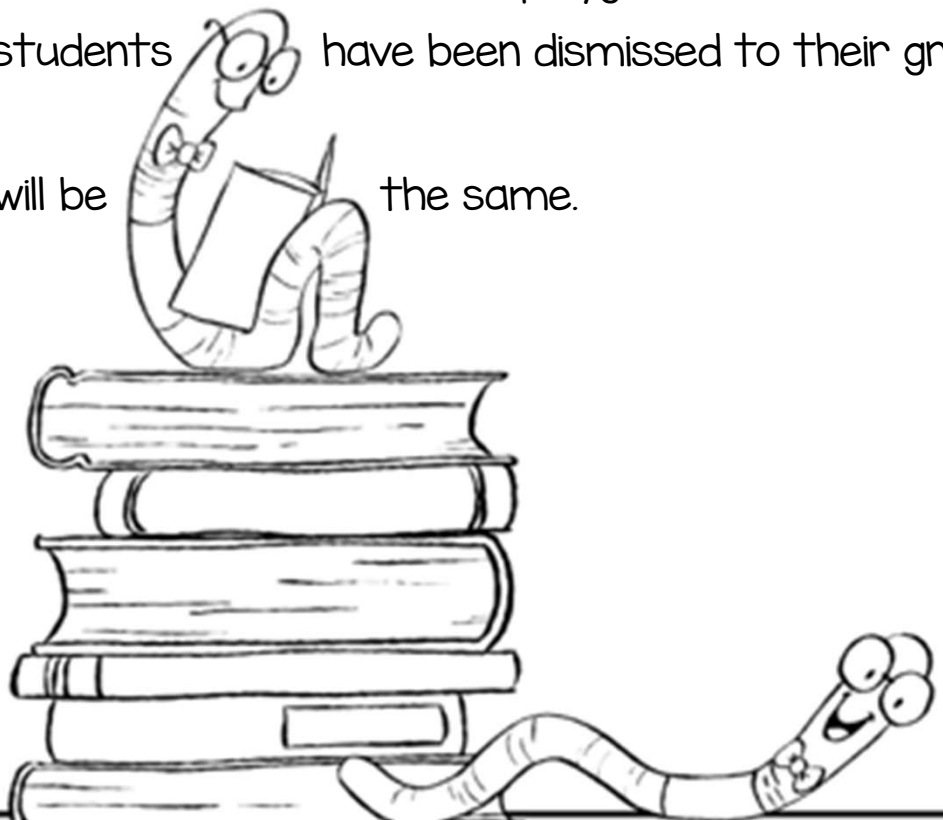
The teacher will dismiss children one at a time to their grown ups.

Grown ups should meet their child by the playground gates. Children will not be allowed to walk across the parking lot.

Dismiss from Classroom

If weather or time does not permit us to get outdoors, we will play in the gym. Students should be picked up by the classroom doors, not the gym, if we are playing inside rather than on the playground. Please stay in the hallway until all students have been dismissed to their grown up.

All other procedures will be the same.



PreK Adult Helpers

We will have one adult helper in class each day. These tasks are guidelines to help you know what to do. Arrival times and cleaning guidelines are the only “musts” on this page.

Arrive 15 minutes before class time and plan to stay about 15 minutes after class to assist with set up and clean up. Please keep your child with you during these times.

Tubs - Play with the children on the floor. Assist/supervise tub games and help with clean up

Circle Time - Finish any preparations for centers, then join class in circle. This is a good time to clean items from the tubs, if needed.

Tables/Centers - The teacher will provide activities that children can be invited to do with the adults in the classroom. No more than 3 children per table! Helpers are also encouraged to engage with the children in centers throughout the room.

Clean up - Clear and clean tables and assist children with clean up. *no cleaning solutions should be used yet.

Bathroom Break- Ensure community water pitchers are filled. Sanitize the table using the bleach solution spray bottle. Set out small water cups, napkins and small plates if needed.

Snack - Please encourage good table manners. Converse with the children and help them clean up their own spills. When finished with the snack, sanitize tables again.

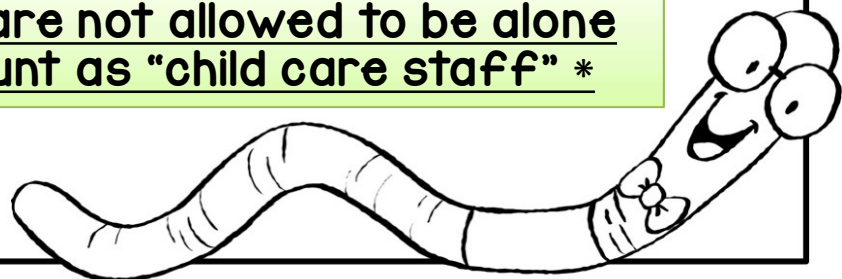
Do not sanitize the tables until all children have left the area.

Backpacks - Assist students as needed while packing up. Encourage independence!

Recess - If going outside, helper will walk with the class through the parking lot. Then it is OK to return to classroom to begin the cleaning & set up jobs..

Classroom Cleaning - All surfaces must be disinfected daily. Clorox wipes and/or the bleach-water cleaning solution may be used during this time. A basket of “yuck” toys (items exposed to body fluids or put in a child’s mouth) will need to be washed and sanitized daily. See the cleaning notebook for details.

***Please note: Class helpers are not allowed to be alone with children and do not count as “child care staff” ***



Snack

The adult helpers are responsible for providing snack for the class on their word day. Snacks can be individual servings or large unopened packages that the helper serves to the students. Snacks should be placed on small plates, napkins, or paper towels. If something needs to be prepared, such as cutting up fruit, this can be done in the church kitchen. **We encourage cutting items like fruit into smaller bite-size pieces.**

We love giving the children opportunities to be independent! We only use water for the drink and the children get to practice pouring their own water into a cup.

Snacks should be healthy and be in a combination of fruit, veggie, or protein and a carb. Below is a list of *suggested* snack items to give you some ideas. Your child may have a different favorite healthy snack that they would like to share with his/her classmates!

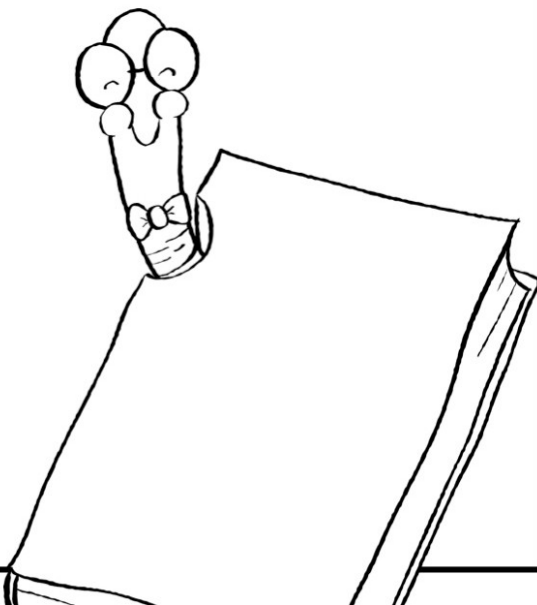
Fruit/Veggie/Proteins

Bananas
Yogurt or yogurt tubes
Baby carrots
Unsweetened applesauce
Cheese sticks
Apple slices
Freeze dried strawberries

Carb

pretzels
popcorn
Goldfish crackers
Pirate's Booty
whole grain crackers

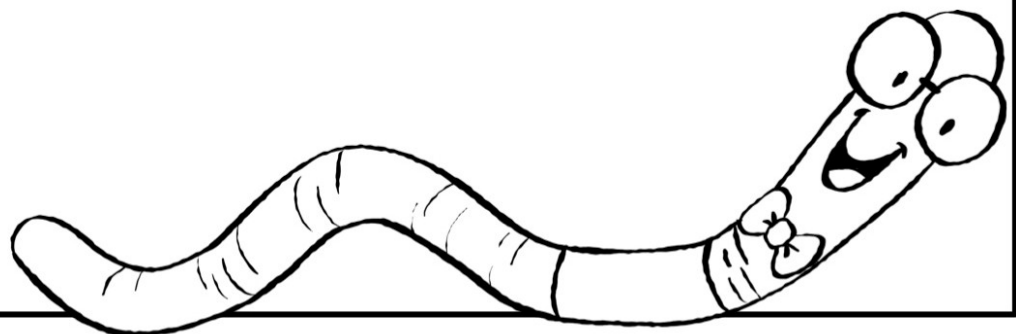
*** Special note: We are a Nut-Free Classroom! Please check all packaging to *ensure foods are made in nut-free facilities*. Thank you!***



Guidelines for Adults Working with Young Children in the Classroom

- **Cultivate a calm attitude** when talking to or working with children. A quiet manner helps prevent excitement and over-stimulation.
- **When giving directions, be sure that the child understands.** As you talk with children, get to their level both in your choice of words and by bending down.
- **Children are not forced to participate.** Some children need an opportunity to observe before they are willing to try a new activity or participate in a group experience.
- **Give the child a choice of action when feasible.** Ask, "Where would you like to put your train, here or there?" This gives the child a personal interest in the situation and develops his initiative and independence.
- **Let the children learn by experience.** Encourage them to help themselves and help only when it is necessary to avoid a feeling of failure or discouragement. Perhaps you could do it faster and better, but by doing it themselves, children are learning.
- **When children are in social conflict,** let them work it through, if they can.
- Remember that **sharing is a foreign concept for small children.**
- Disapprove of the act, not the child.

Most importantly, relax and enjoy yourself!



Communication

There are several methods for getting information out to you.

Take home folders- students should bring these to class every day. The teacher will send monthly newsletters, Scholastic order forms, and other class items home. Please check them regularly!

ClassDojo App- *new this year* Our class will maintain a ClassDojo page for group communications. . We will use it to share photos of daily class happenings, reminders about class and school events, and more! You can also use this for communicating directly with the teacher.

Email/Text- Directly texting the teacher and/or the class representative if you have any questions or concerns is still best for urgent communications.

Dressing For School

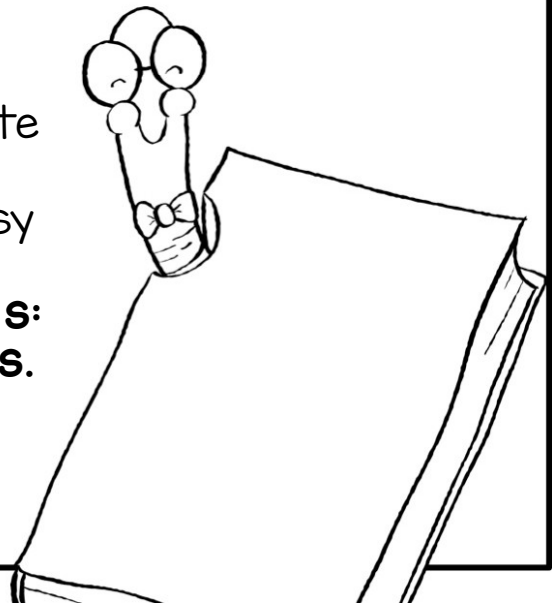
Please send your child with weather appropriate clothes and shoes every day.

- Clothing should be casual, comfortable, and suitable for play.
- Be prepared for your child to be sitting and playing on the floor.
- Flip flops and shoes that fall off easily are not playground friendly shoes and present a hazard. We find closed toe shoes are best for play.
- In cold weather, it is important that every child is wearing a warm coat, hat, and gloves or mittens. Outside play is permitted with temperatures above 32 degrees.

Extra Clothes

Accidents happen, especially in a preschool classroom! Please keep a seasonally appropriate change of clothes in your child's backpack. Storing them in a plastic bag is easy and convenient.

**Please try to include the following items:
underwear, socks, shirt, pants or shorts.**



Toys/Personal items

To minimize disruption, please try to keep personal toys at home. This prevents favorite items from getting lost or broken in class. Comfort toys are allowed, but please communicate with the teacher about this in advance.

Parent-Teacher Conferences

Parent-Teacher Conferences are held in April. The meetings last approximately 15 minutes. Watch for information as this time approaches.

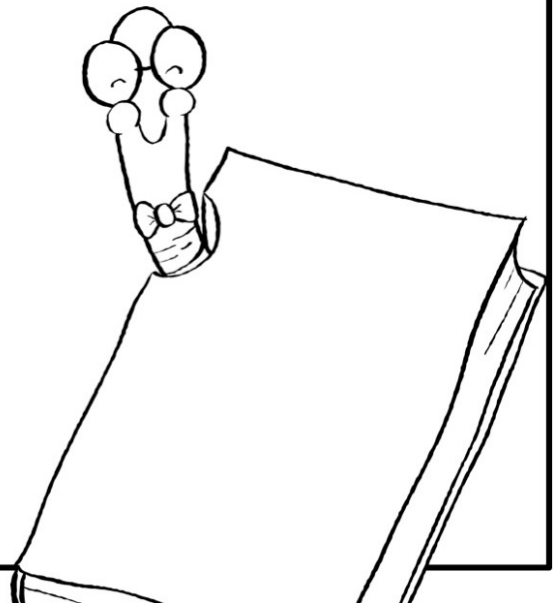
Registration for the next year of preschool is in December. If you have questions or concerns about whether your child is ready for kindergarten or if another year of preschool is appropriate, please reach out to the teacher and she will provide guidance.

Birthdays

Helpers will have the opportunity to be a scheduled helper in class on or near their child's birthday (or chosen day to celebrate).

You are welcome to bring in a small treat or special store-bought snack that day. Please consider keeping cupcakes and other treats to small bite-sized portions. We have found over time that those small treats are just the right amount for snack time.

Some families also like to bring in a small non-food treat for the whole class. This is fine, but please distribute these items directly to backpacks or hand them out at pick-up time.



Our Class Pets

We have a class pet! The AM class pet is Pickles, and she's a *stuffed* dog. Our PM class will have their own dog (name to be determined!), but the process will be the same for each class.

Beginning in October, each child will have a chance to keep Pickles for the weekend. You can take her everywhere, and we would love to have pictures or drawings of their adventures together (ex. Pickles at the ballpark, Pickles at the dinner table).

When it's your child's turn, we will send a backpack home containing Pickles and the story binder. On the following Monday, your child will get to share about their adventures with the class!

